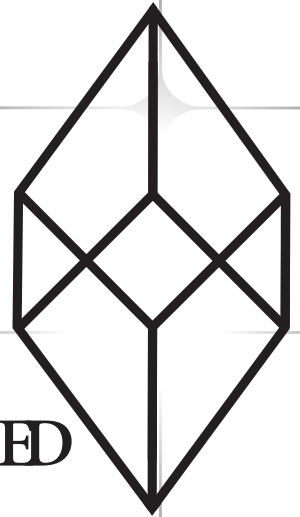


Drott

Where two opposing armies battle through tactics and strategy.



ED

Drott is a game where two armies oppose one another to achieve one of three goals; To kill the opponent's king, to conquer his fort, or to march one's king unopposed into the castle.

The board

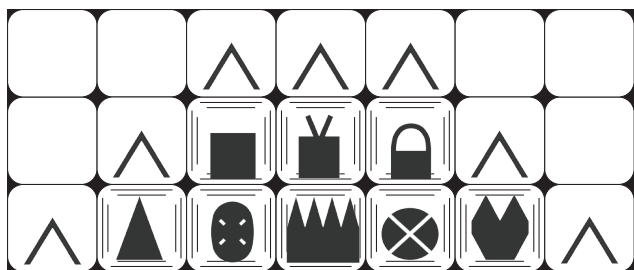
The marked fields on the top and bottom are the forts. This is where all the pieces start out.

The central square is the castle. This is where the king hopes to go in order to win the game.

The three outer rows on each sides are called the flanks. The marked field in the middle is considered the "center," in the middle of which is the castle.

Starting positions.

In the piece placements illustration you can see the starting position for both players. The Vs are Skjoldings. The pieces are, from the top left; The berserker, the spearman and the bowman. Beneath from the left are; the elf, wolf, king, hunter, and dwarf.



Winning the game.

There are three ways to win. 1. You can either defeat the opponents king, or; 2. You can have one of your pieces in their fort until your next turn, or; 3. You can march your king into the castle, and have him stand there until your next turn. Note: If a king makes it into the castle, checking him will not help, as the opponent will win on his turn, when the king is in fact still standing there.

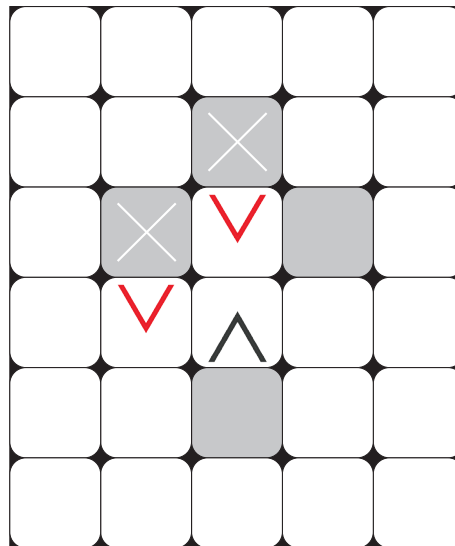
Movement and attacking.

Movement pattern for all pieces are found on a separate sheet found in the box.

Pieces attack by landing on the square of the opponent piece. The opponent's piece is then removed from the game.

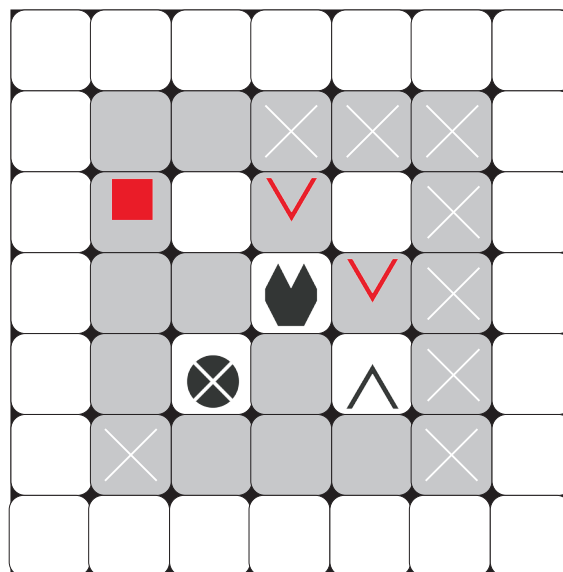
In Drott pieces cannot jump or move through lines of pieces standing together, no matter if they are placed diagonally or orthogonally, friend or foe.

All pieces must move in a straight line to their target square. The line is considered straight, if one can draw a straight line from somewhere in the starting square to somewhere in the ending square.



In the example to the above, black's skjolding cannot make the forward move because he cannot jump, and not slide in between his opponents pieces because they are standing next to each other in what we call a shieldwall.

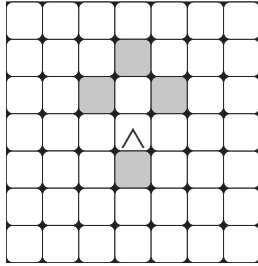
Below we see a more complicated example. The dwarf has many options to move; It can capture any of the red pieces, or move to a total of nine free squares. The other squares are either behind friendly or enemy pieces.



Notice that for all the squares the dwarf can move to, a straight line can be drawn from the dwarf's square to the ending square without passing through another piece.

Skjolding Movement

The most populous piece, and the most important to master, is the Skjolding. This is how the Skjolding moves.



As you can see, the space right in front of the Skjolding is clear. Anyone can stand there to block the skjolding.

To make the best use of Skjoldings, set them up in chains, each Skjolding protecting the next. Because any one of them is less worth than a piece, they stand in relative safety.

Below is a diagram of how all the pieces move. Pieces can only move to the dark squares seen here, and no farther. The pieces are positioned here as they would

be at the start of the game, only they would have a row of Skjoldings in front of them.

Tactics and Strategy

Tactics are about the combat on the ground. Strategy is about the overall plan. Below is a selection of observations to get you into the interesting aspects of this game.

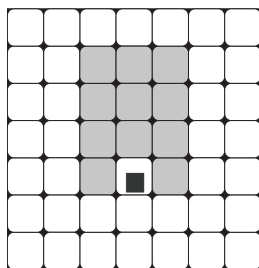
Basic Tactics

Many of the tactical considerations that were developed for chess are also applicable to Drott. Forks, revealed checks, pinning and such are all part of the tactical repertoire. A fork is that one of your pieces attack two of theirs. Pinning is when an attack hits a piece that, if it were removed, would also hit a more important piece - making that first piece unsound to move.

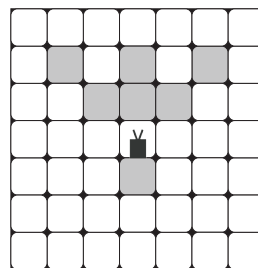
Exchanges should also be made so that your bad pieces are changed for their good pieces. In general those pieces that have greater freedom of movement are better than pieces with more restricted movements.

Basic Strategy

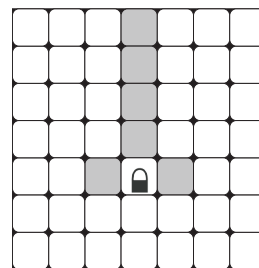
Generally in Drott one would like to get some control over the center of the board. This ensures better maneuverability for your own pieces, and hinders the opposing king to wander into the center too easily. One should also try to develop one's officers so that



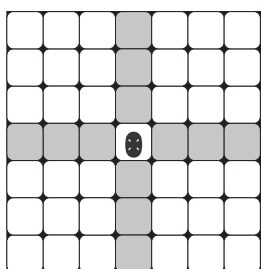
Berserker



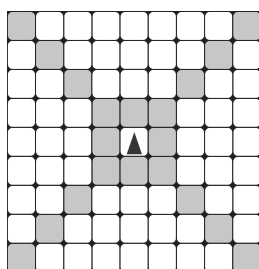
Spear- man



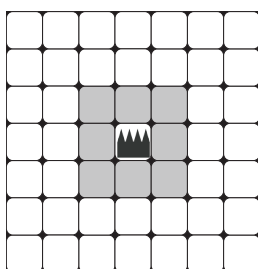
Bowman



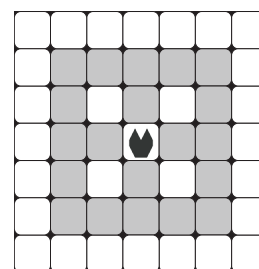
Wolf



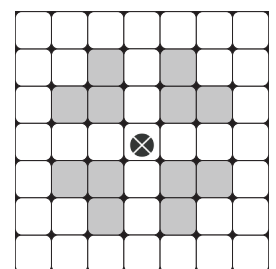
Elf



King



Dwarf



Hunter

one's flanks aren't open.

After development it helps to generate a general plan. It is normally too hard to see a direct route to a win, but there are many small goals to work towards, for example; 1. Materiell advantage. Try to corner one of his pieces and take it. 2. Space. More maneuverability on your side will make it easier to shift your forces around, which is a good offensive plan. 3. Initiative. Try to find a way to always threaten and get your opponent to work on plans you set them, that will give you the advantage of controlling the flow of the game. 4. Tempo. If you know what their plan is, try to play in such a way that he needs to make moves that are not part of that plan. That will make you more efficient, so that your actions count more towards achieving a your goal. 5. Development. Bring out your pieces so that they are ready to strike. 6. King safety. Make sure that your king is not easily attacked.

There are many concepts in here that will be unfamiliar to the average game player, so I've taken the liberty of including a small concept library at the end of this manual.

Advanced Tactics and Strategy

Opening play

It is important to develop your Skjoldings to release the other pieces from their hold. Diagonally placed Skjoldings protect each other. The central Skjolding is out of sync with the rest, and the decision must be made if you want to sacrifice a tempo to "straighten" him.

Mid game

The mid game is starting as development is finishing. Often it can help to have an elf on the flank to threaten stray Skjoldings. Be careful in using the pieces that have a hard time retreating. The berserker in particular is best used for protecting the many Skjoldings trying to occupy the center.

Berserker

The berserker, because of his wide field of action, is good at capturing the king. During opening play, it may be better to hold him back to support pawn advances, but, in time, the lines will break, and then one can try to steer the berserker towards the opponents castle. To defeat a berserker, either get out of his way, or flank him and drive him into a corner, a bad trade, or simply take him.

Shieldwall

Diagonally placed Skjoldings cover one another, and are as close to impenetrable as can be. How far ahead to have your shield-wall, and on which side it is strongest is a tactical and strategic consideration. A far advanced wall can open you up to flanking attacks, but a retardant one yields too much of the center, and hinders maneuverability.

Flanks

The flanks are the three outer rows that are not covered by Skjoldings. Much of the tactical action will happen here, and it is important to march some of the more maneuverable officers towards this line. The can be the basis of attacks, but to be quick on a flank can be costly because of the double advance strategy.

Double Advance

Going forward with only one officer can be a tricky proposition. A single elf can easily escape, but, as an attacking force it's not up to much. Rather the dynamic officers work best in tandem. The Hunter is paired with the Dwarf, and the Wolf with the Elf. Together they can be incredibly effective at going past the flanks to wreak havoc behind enemy territory. Chasing away a lonely elf can net you valuable space on the right flank.

King Advance.

Advancing with the king is costly in terms of tempo, so why should you do it? By controlling the center, advancing the king can be a threat at simply taking the castle and winning. This can force your opponent to make rash decisions that will win you the game long term. Advancing the king should be about winning the initiative, and drawing valuable resources of your opponent towards hindering you, so that you can make a double attack on the flanks or on the fort, on supporting material or any such complex double maneuver. Just remember that you will be leaving yourself exposed for a fort take over if you are not careful.

Exploiting a material advantage

Tempo is important in Drott because pieces cannot cover the whole board in one leap. This means that if you have the material advantage a double attack on both sides of the board, will necessarily leave one of the sides more exposed. When she is defending one

flank, attack the other. Somewhere's gotta give.

Blocking with officers.

Even if you do not markedly advance your officers, at least liberate them enough to let them watch the flank. That way, it is harder to become surprised by a flanking attack aimed at "getting behind enemy lines", or even a plan to take the fort.

Optimizing for reach

Advancing an elf one square, or a berserker two, is a waste if you need to do the same thing the round after. Not exploiting the reach of your pieces will in summation lose valuable tempo, and may cost you a lot of space on the board. The quicker player exploits the reach of the pieces.

Use of the minor pieces

The berserker, spear-man and bowman are all limited in their capacity for retreat. Use them sparingly in the opening play, mostly to cover pawn advancements. Maybe hold one back for the king to hide behind in case of a breach on the flank later in the game.

Local and global influence

Local tactical fights on the flank can and will have ramifications other places on the board. A retreat on the flank can open up maneuvers for attack on the center; which, if it collapses necessitates a shift on tactics on the right flank. Seeing the connection between local and global scales is necessary for expert play.

Sniping the castle

A good tactic for preventing the opponents king is to have a defender marking that square from far away. The bowman is an excellent choice. For the king to enter, he would either have to take out the defender, or block it with a piece or skjolding.

Advanced pieces

In the late game, a dynamic piece near his castle can be a valuable asset. The threat to invade his fortress will force him to keep some of his more valuable defenders back, perhaps hindering him from getting a king into the center.

Middle pawn straightening

The center skjolding is not synced up with the others to jump forward to a protected position. Straightening this pawn by taking a backward step

costs a tempo, but it might be worth it for a more solid center.

Which direction to take with skjoldings.

In skjolding exchanges there are two things to think about; Does the result strengthen my hold on the center? And, which flank is my weakest? The weakest side should have the stronger skjolding chain, because there your officers are least strong to resist a flanking attack.

Words of thanks and a call for testers

A game like this does not fall fully formed from a creators brow. It is the work of long nights, long traditions and many play-tests.

The game was principally inspired by three ancient abstract board games; Chess, Hnefatafl and Go. The exciting army is taken from chess, an idea of a dynamic asymmetry is taken from Hnefatafl, and Go, with it's bigger boards, has inspired the idea of local tactical battles that have greater strategic effects.

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In addition I would also like to thank my play testers; Hanne E. Thomassen, Kolbeinn, Pål Thomassen, Caroline Bergendahl, Camilla Kvernevik, Ole Martin Maalen

SKAKKTAFI IS IN NEED OF PLAY TESTERS.
FOR MORE INFORMATION, SEND AN E-MAIL TO EMIL.DANIELSEN@GMAIL.COM, OR VISIT WWW.EMILDANIELSEN.COM.

Folding Instructions

Print this page on stiff paper. You may choose whatever colors you want, but the traditional colors are red and white. For pictures of the finished pieces, please visit www.emildanielsen.com. If you don't have colored paper, you can always print on white paper and hand color the pieces.

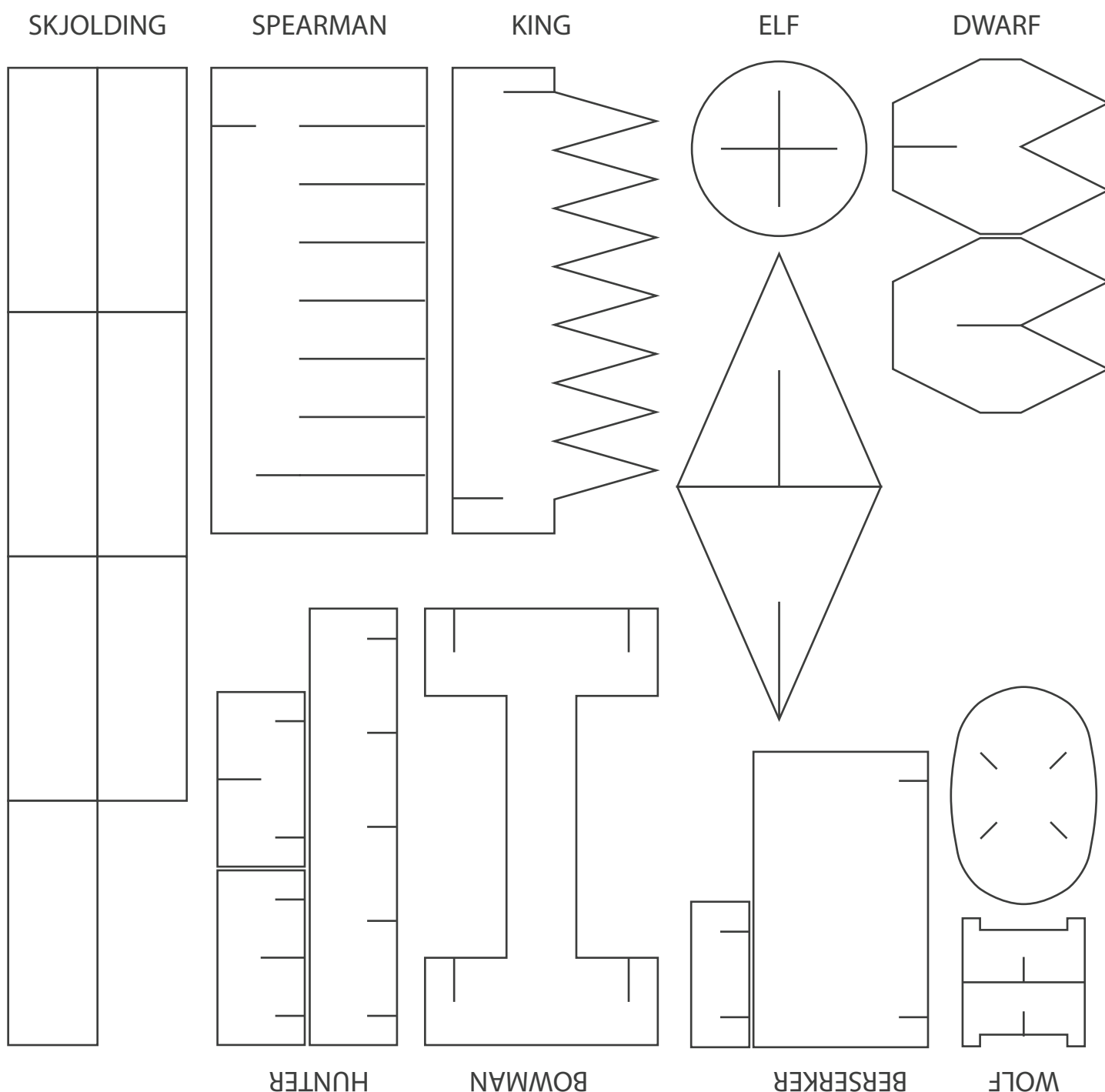
General advice for folding: You will need a sharp knife, a cutting board, and something round to bend the paper around. With pieces which will end up with round features, such as the king spear- man and bowman, it is advisable to pre bend them around a pen or similar, this will give them a nice round

shape when they are put together. Don't bend them too much, or you will lose the tension in the paper needed to hold them together.

Bowman: Pre bend the middle section, which will become the "bow", and the bottom struts, which will become the circular base. Fit the base, so that both tips turn inward.

Skjoldings: Fold in half with a light pressure on the middle to keep the tension in the paper.

Spearman: Roll on the long side around a pen, likewise with the frills on the top to bend them slightly. Lock the ends together so that the tails stick up. Fold all the middle part on the middle and stick



them into the circle.

Hunter: Interlock the two small pieces so they form a cross. On the long part, put the middle cut on the small cut of the cross. put the rest of the circle on from there, with the last two hatches joining on the same arm of the cross..

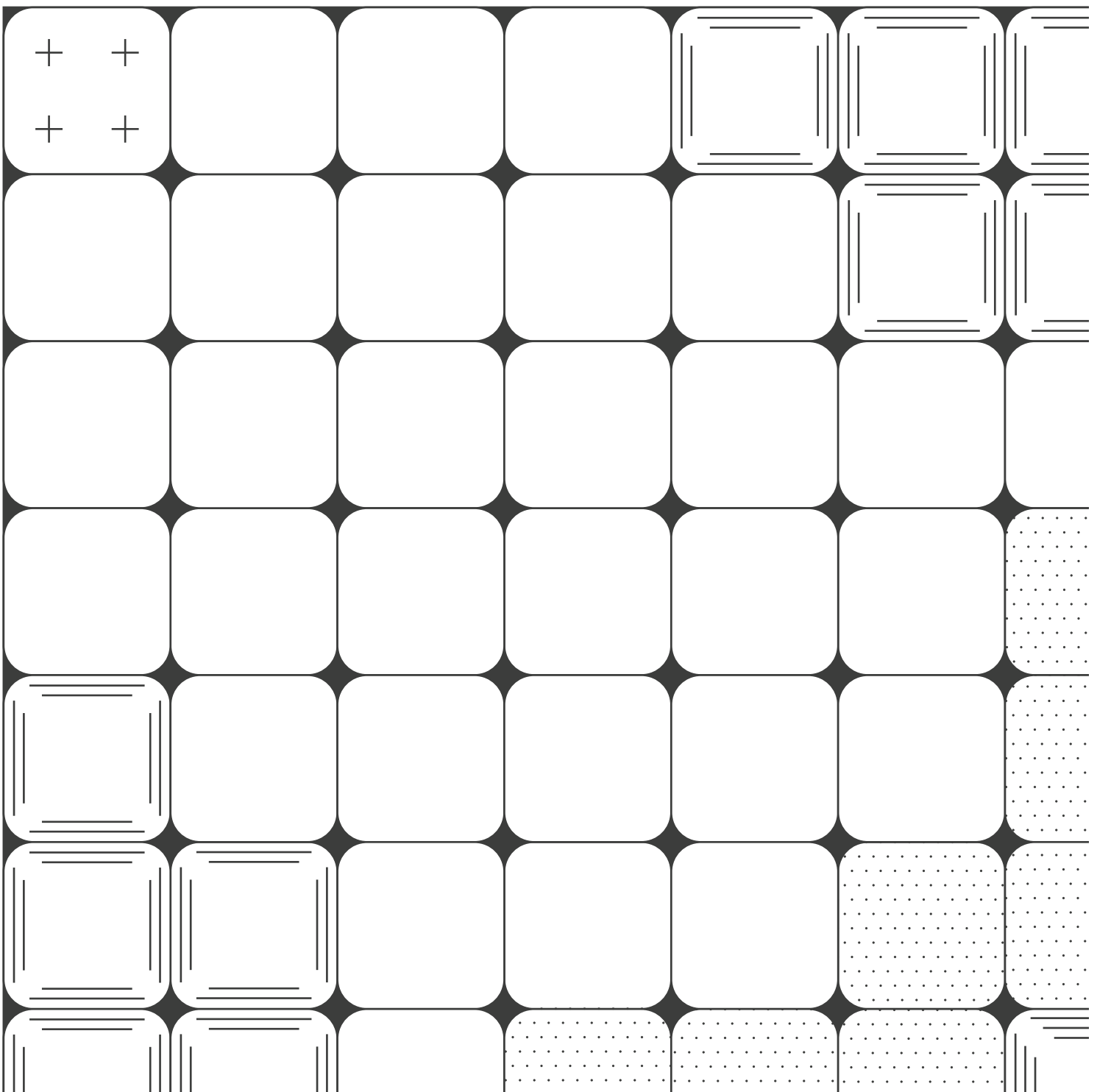
Wolf: Make a cross like on the hunter. Cut holes on the oval shape, and widen them a little with a knife. Mount the oval on the cross.

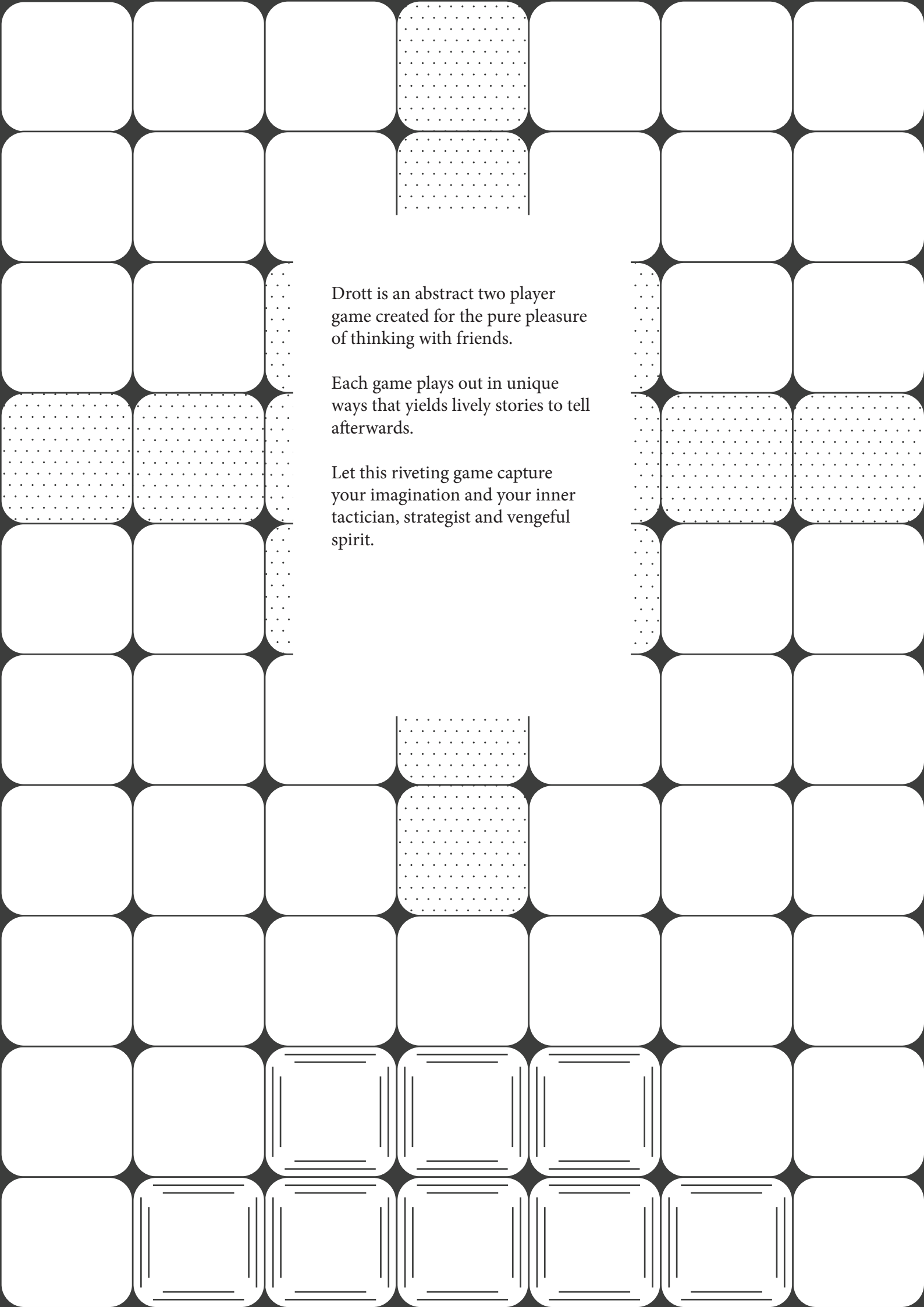
The rest of the pieces are not that hard to get right. A little practice will really improve the quality of the pieces.

Board: This is a fourth of the board. To make the full version, print this page four times.

From there, you will need a way to mount all of these together. The simplest way, is to tape them together on the back, making always sure to make up the center line which, on this page, is on the bottom right corner.

An alternate version is to glue it onto a fift piece of paper, preferably the size of the full Skakktafl board.





Drott is an abstract two player
game created for the pure pleasure
of thinking with friends.

Each game plays out in unique
ways that yields lively stories to tell
afterwards.

Let this riveting game capture
your imagination and your inner
tactician, strategist and vengeful
spirit.